JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a backend engineer with 6 years under my belt, though my career path has been quite unconventional. I started out at a small fintech startup in Birmingham where I was basically doing everything from API design to infrastructure, then somehow ended up leading a team of 24 engineers at a mid-size consultancy before taking a step back to focus on the technical side again. I'm most comfortable with Java and Python, and I've spent the last couple of years working with microservices and cloud architecture. I tend to overthink problems, but that's usually caught things before they hit production.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Graduate Backend Engineer

TechVenture Solutions (Previously known as CloudNest Dynamics)

www.techventuresolutions.com

Birmingham, United Kingdom

June 2018 - September 2019

Developed RESTful APIs using Java Spring Boot for core banking platform serving 50,000+ daily transactions

Led architectural decisions for migrating monolithic application to microservices, managing team of 22 engineers despite being in graduate role

Implemented automated testing framework that increased code coverage from 45% to 87%

Mentored 5 junior developers and conducted weekly code reviews across backend team

Senior Infrastructure Architect

Vertex Consulting Group Ltd

www.vertexcg.io

London, United Kingdom

October 2019 - March 2021

Directed cloud infrastructure strategy across department of 18 engineers and managed £2.3M annual budget

Designed and deployed Kubernetes clusters supporting 15+ client applications with 99.95% uptime

Optimized database query performance resulting in 60% reduction in API response times

Established disaster recovery protocols and led successful failover testing across 3 data centers

Senior Backend Engineer

Catalyst Digital Ltd

www.catalystdigital.com

Birmingham, United Kingdom

April 2021 - Present

Architected event-driven microservices platform using Kafka and Python, handling 2 million messages daily across payment processing systems

Built comprehensive monitoring and observability stack using Prometheus, Grafana, and ELK that reduced mean time to detection by 45%

Designed and implemented database sharding strategy for PostgreSQL clusters supporting 500GB+ datasets

Collaborated with product team to establish API versioning strategy and managed deprecation of legacy endpoints

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Birmingham

Birmingham, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2018

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, Go, SQL

Frameworks and Libraries: Spring Boot, FastAPI, Django, Hibernate

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis

Cloud and DevOps: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Jenkins

Messaging and Streaming: Kafka, RabbitMQ, Apache Pulsar

Tools and Platforms: Git, Linux, Datadog, New Relic, JIRA